

Unit 9 The Crew and Its Tasks

The Master

Responsibility

Exercise 1

We find the Master of the ship, Captain Andrew James on the bridge.

- Good morning Captain, we would like to ask you a few questions. How would you describe the Captain's or Master's role on a modern ship today?
- Well, first of all you might say that it **<involves>** an enormous responsibility. The Captain **<is in charge of>** everything and everyone on board. He has complete responsibility **<for running the ship>** while at sea and for the **<safety>** of the crew, passengers and cargo. Whenever there is an **<emergency>** or a serious problem of any kind I will be called upon. I do not **<stand a watch>** but in reality I am **<on duty>** 24 hours a day. I'll be on the bridge, conning the ship in foul **<weather>** or **<fog>** until the danger is over, for however long it takes, be it **<24, 38 or 72 hours>**, and no matter how **<tired>** or exhausted I am. I am also the last to abandon ship in case of a **<disaster>**.

Exercise 2

1. The First Mate was uncertain about what to do so he **<called upon>** the Captain.
2. Who **<is in charge of>** this operation?
3. The Captain is always called upon in **<an emergency>**.
4. Captain James had **<been on duty>** for 24 hours in **<foul>** weather.
5. No wonder he was **<exhausted>**.
6. Who is the last man **<to abandon>** ship in a disaster?
7. During the storm the Captain **<cons>** the ship while the helmsman **<steers>** the
1. correct course.
8. A Master's work **<involves>** an **<enormous>** responsibility.
9. Does a Master **<stand a watch>** like the crew members?

The Master Supervision

Exercise 1

The Master of a ship is not actually a crew member. But I have to supervise the work of any other officer or crew member on board. I **1. direct** or **2. oversee** crew members who steer the vessel, **3. determine** its position, **4. communicate with** other vessels, **5. operate** and **6. overhaul** engines, **7. perform maintenance**, **8. handle lines** or operate vessel equipment of any kind.

This means I have to be as familiar with the work done by stewards and cooks in the Steward's department, engineers, the Engine department as I am with the work of the Mates on the bridge and the **9. Able Seamen** and **10. deckhands** in the Deck department. All this makes me into a kind of Personnel Manager – it is important to maintain a good morale, team spirit and atmosphere on board.

- 1. guide**
- 2. supervise**
- 3. decide**
- 4. have contact with**
- 5. to make something work**
- 6. take into parts and check**
- 7. service**
- 8. to work with the ship's ropes**
- 9. a senior seaman**
- 10. a so-called ordinary seaman**

The Master

The Company Agent

Exercise 1

The Master of a merchant vessel is the **<agent>** of the company, which owns the ship.

When we are at sea my bridge officers and myself maintain the Ship's Log and **<records>** of the ship's movements.

There are also quite a number of other documents for **<dealing>** with port authorities and Port State Control.

Today port **<security regulations>** have become very strict - the **<ISPS Code>** has increased our work as well.

Exercise 2

<Port State Control> refers to the inspection of foreign ships in national ports to ensure that the condition of the ship and its equipment comply with the requirements of international regulations and that the ship is manned and operated in compliance with these rules.

A **<Bill of Lading>** is a document that gives the terms of a contract between a shipper and a transportation company. It serves as a document of title, a contract of carriage and a receipt for goods.

The **<Ship's Log>** is a log book where all information about the ship's movements and events during a voyage is recorded.

<ISPS> stands for International Ship and Ports Facility Security Code.

A list of all the crew members on board is the **<Muster Roll / Crew List>**
<Clearance> refers to a permission from someone in authority.

A detailed summary of the total cargo of a vessel, used principally for Customs purposes, is called the **<Cargo Manifest>**. The document lists in detail all the bills of lading issued by a carrier or its agent or master for a specific voyage.

A person whose job it is to deal with business for someone else is an **<agent>**.

The services and personnel in port that take care of loading and unloading the vessel are called **<stevedoring services>**.

A document showing that the vessel is properly registered with the authorities is the **<Certificate of Registry>**.

A plan for overall stowage of the cargo on the vessel is called the **<Stowage Plan>**.

The Deck Department

The Chief Officer / The Chief Mate

The First Officer

Exercise 1

The crew members **<perform maintenance>** on the equipment both on deck and in the engine room.

The Master **<maintains>** the Ship's Log and records of the ship's movements.

The Mate **<checks>** ship's position on charts.

The First Mate **<monitors>** the bridge instruments and their readings.

Down in the Engine room they often have **<to overhaul>** the engines while in port.

The deckhands make sure that the deck equipment **<is in good working order/is in good condition>**.

The radar is not **<functioning>**.

Do you know **<to operate>** this radar?

The deckhand **<handles>** the lines when casting off.

The First Mate **<assigns>** duties to the deck crew.

Sometimes it is necessary **<to post>** a lookout to study the surroundings.

The Chief Engineer **<directs/guides>** his engineers, oilers and pumpmen in their work.

The First Mate **<supervises/oversees>** work on deck.

You must **<prepare>** the ship for loading.

The Chief Mate **<plans>** the loading and discharging.

The First Mate **<looks after>** the deck equipment.

He also has to **<see to it>** that it is in good working order.

The Master **<is responsible for>** the safety of the whole ship the cargo and the crew.

He **<answers to/is responsible to>** the Company that owns the ship.

The Chief Mate is second **<in command>**.

He **<is responsible to/answers to>** the Master.

If the Master dies or is incapacitated, the Chief Mate **<takes command>**.

During a real emergency the Chief Mate **<takes charge of>** the whole scene in rescue operations.

That was a bad mistake; you will have **<to answer for>** it.

Exercise 2

1. When there is danger on board, the crew will hear a signal which tells them to assemble at their **<emergency|muster>** stations.
2. If there has been a leakage on board or fire causing damage the First Officer might send out a **<damage>** control team.
3. To leave the ship in case of emergency is called to **<abandon>** ship.
4. Practice sessions covering the use of fire-fighting and life-saving equipment are called **<fire>** drills and **<boat>** drills.
5. A list of the vessel's crew showing their duties in a distress is the **<muster>** list.

The Deck Department

The Chief Officer / The Chief Mate

The Second Officer

Exercise 1

The Second Officer or Second Mate is, traditionally, the ship's navigational officer. I have to **<ensure>** that bridge electronics, navigational and alarm systems and the ship's navigational lights are in good working order. I regularly **<check>** bridge instruments and **<make sure>** that up-to-date charts and navigational publications are available on board. I also **<correct>** the charts and **<update>** the navigational publications if necessary.

I **<provide>** The Master with information on transit routes to ports of call including Sailing Directions, Coast Pilot, Light List and Tide and Current tables and any other source of information that might be required before entering or leaving port. Finally, I **<plot>** the voyage track and **<work**

out> the course. In the event of GPS failure I **<take>** terrestrial or celestial fixes for positioning. I **<assist>** the Captain in taking the ship in and out of ports. In addition to all this I am also the ship's medical officer.

Exercise 2

1. The Second Officer **assists** the Master in taking the ship in and out of ports.
2. He also **plots** the voyage track on the charts.
3. It is important to **check** the bridge instruments from time to time to see that they are working properly.
4. The Second Officer **ensures** that everything is in order.
5. He also **provides** the Master with information on transit routes to ports.
6. Because of changes in the fairway it is sometimes necessary to **correct** the charts.
7. Nowadays information rather quickly becomes out-dated, so be sure to **update** navigational publications from time to time.

Exercise 3

1. A fix taken from the stars and sky is a **celestial** fix.
2. A fix taken from landmarks or seamarks is a **terrestrial** fix.
3. A publication that gives information on lighthouses and buoys is the **Light List**.
4. A route from the port of departure to the port of destination is a **transit** route.
5. Working out or calculating the positioning in one word is called **positioning**.
6. Instructions and advice on how to navigate in a particular area are called **Sailing directions**.
7. In the waters off, for example, the British coast you will need The Tide and **Current Tables**.
8. EPIRB is short for **Emergency Position Indicating Beacon**.
9. Another word for "to show" is to **indicate**.
10. The main navigation lights are:
 - Port Sidelight, colour **red**
 - **Starboard** Sidelight, colour **green**
 - Top **Masthead** Light, colour **white**
 - **Stern** Light, colour white

11. The radio equipment, EPIRBs, flares and smoke signals are all part of the ship's **alarm system**.
12. A light signal in an emergency is a rocket or **flare**.
13. The Admiralty List of Lights and the Rules of the Road are navigational **publications**.

The Deck Department

The Chief Officer / The Chief Mate

The Able Seaman

Exercise 1

1. Another word for deck equipment is deck **<gear>**.
2. The equipment for tying up the vessel to the quay is the **<mooring>** equipment.
3. The equipment for getting the cargo on board is the **<loading gear/loading equipment>**.
4. Another word for corridor is **<passageway>**.
5. A traditional word for the seaman who steers a vessel is the **<helmsman>** and sometimes the quartermaster.
6. To remove dirt or paint from, for example, the deck with a sharp edge is to **<scrape>**.
7. To tidy up a piece of equipment and prepare it for special treatment is to **<prime>**.
8. To break off small pieces of something is to **<chip>**.
9. A term used in navigational vocabulary is a **<nautical>** term.
10. Another word for an ordinary seaman is **<deckhand>**.
11. Navigational lights are sometimes called **<running lights>**.
12. The regulations for fairway navigation are found in the **<Rules of the Road>**.
13. Ramps, doors, cranes and lifts are part of the loading **<equipment/gear>**.
14. The windlass, ropes cables and wires are part of the **<mooring>** equipment.

The Engine Department

The Chief Engineer

A Marine Engineer

Exercise 1

1. The main engine was not **running** properly, so we had to make use of the **auxiliary** engine.
2. The Chief Engineer decided on repairs and reported on the **defects** to the Master.
3. Engine trouble may **affect** the ship's performance.
4. The Chief engineer never wastes anything and sees to it that there is an **economical** use of fuel, supplies and stores.
5. Today he is looking over the **inventory** to see that nothing is missing.
6. He **monitors** fuel and water supplies every day and supervises **bunkering** when the vessel is filling up tanks.
7. It is important to **specify** the tasks for the crew, so that they know **exactly** what to do on a watch.
8. Today the machinery is very specialized and needs different kind of **service**.
9. On tankers **pumpmen** operate cargo tanks.
10. In olden days work in the engine room included a little bit of everything and an engineer had to be a **jack of all trades**.
11. But today engineers have to have a great deal of **know-how** to carry out their work **successfully**.

The Crew and Its Tasks

Revision task

The Captain

- is the company agent
- is responsible for the safety of the ship, crew and cargo

The Chief Mate

- is head of the Deck Department
- plans and supervises loading
- is second in command

The First Mate

- is the ship's training officer
- is in charge during Boat Drills
- carries out maintenance on deck equipment

The Second Mate

- is traditionally the ship's navigational officer
- corrects and updates the charts
- plots the voyage on charts

Able Seaman

- stands a watch as quartermaster
- scrapes and wire-brushes the hull
- carries out maintenance on deck equipment

The Chief Engineer

- is head of the Engine Department
- advises the Master on fuel requirements